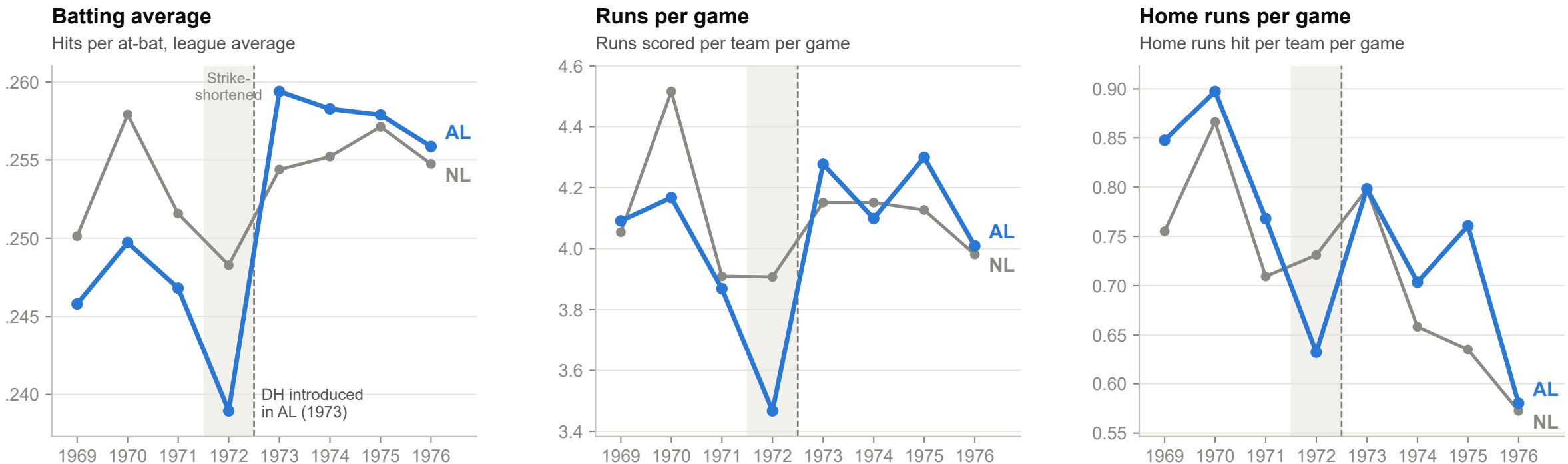
With the DH, the AL went from trailing the NL in batting average every season to leading every season

Yearly league averages, American League (AL, blue) vs. National League (NL, gray), 1969–1976.
The AL slumped in 1972, far more than the NL; all three AL measures rebounded when the DH arrived in 1973.



Source: SABR Lahman Baseball Database (2025). Notes: Averages are across the 12 teams in each league. 1972 (shaded) was shortened by a player strike; all measures are per game or per at-bat, so seasons remain comparable.
Descriptive only; the difference-in-differences estimates give the effect of the DH.